



FREE GUIDE · FOR SCHOOL & K-12 HEALTH

# The School Health Office's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Student sharps, expired EpiPens, and unclaimed medications — handled safely and documented.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

## EpiPens are the surprise.

School nurse offices handle student diabetic sharps, emergency epinephrine, and expired or unclaimed student medications. Two catch schools off guard: sharps aren't regular trash, and expired EpiPens are P-listed federally hazardous waste. This guide covers every stream, including that one.

### The good news

One vendor can take your student sharps, expired EpiPens, and unclaimed medications — with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract. Simple enough for a busy nurse's office.

### AT A GLANCE

## Who regulates what.

| Agency | What it covers in your practice                                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OSHA   | Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training. |
| EPA    | RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.     |
| DEA    | Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.      |
| DOT    | Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.                 |
| State  | Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.                           |

### THE STREAMS

## Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

### WASTE STREAM 01

## Sharps

Diabetic and emergency sharps in the nurse's office.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Student insulin pens & needles
- Lancets
- Emergency injection sharps

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

**THE RULE** · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Sharps mail-back kit.

#### Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

### WASTE STREAM 02

## Hazardous drugs — epinephrine

The surprise stream — expired EpiPens and epinephrine are P-listed federally hazardous waste, not ordinary trash or medication waste.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired epinephrine auto-injectors (EpiPens)
- Other P-listed drugs
- Characteristic hazardous waste

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous student meds
- Sharps

**THE RULE** · EPA RCRA — P-listed drugs like epinephrine must be segregated and destroyed to EPA standards.

**DISPOSE WITH** · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit.

#### Tip

Expired EpiPens are P-listed — never in the regular trash or with ordinary medications.

### WASTE STREAM 03

## Pharmaceutical waste

Expired and unclaimed student medications.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired student meds
- Unclaimed / end-of-year medications
- Non-controlled, non-hazardous meds

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

**THE RULE** · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit or on-site deactivation.

#### Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

### WASTE STREAM 04

## Controlled substances

Any controlled student medications kept in the office.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Unclaimed controlled student meds
- Discontinued controls
- Wasted doses

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

**THE RULE** · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs; on-site deactivation meets non-retrievable guidance.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Controlled / medication mail-back kit, or on-site deactivation, to DEA standards.

#### Tip

On-site deactivation lets you render controls non-retrievable immediately — useful when meds shouldn't leave the building.

### YOUR CHECKLIST

## The school health compliance checklist.

- ☐ Student diabetic and emergency sharps in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Expired EpiPens and epinephrine destroyed as P-listed hazardous waste.

- ☐ Expired and unclaimed student medications destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Any controlled student meds rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ Nurse and staff trained on safe disposal and bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per district and state rules.

#### QUESTIONS SCHOOL NURSES ASK

## Your school health questions, answered.

### How do we dispose of expired EpiPens?

As P-listed RCRA-hazardous waste — segregated and destroyed to EPA standards. Expired epinephrine is federally hazardous, not regular trash or medication waste. This is the most common school-health mistake.

### What do we do with student sharps?

Insulin and emergency sharps go in an FDA-cleared sharps container and a prepaid sharps mail-back kit.

### How do we handle unclaimed student medications at year-end?

Non-controlled meds are destroyed as pharmaceutical waste; any controls are rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41 — all documented.

### Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

#### THE EASY WAY

## Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits sized to a school health office — student sharps, expired EpiPens, and unclaimed medications — destroyed at our DEA-registered facility with a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

#### QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

| Waste stream                     | The right path                          |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Student sharps                   | Sharps mail-back kit                    |
| Expired EpiPens /<br>epinephrine | RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit (P-listed) |

| Waste stream                  | The right path                        |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Unclaimed non-controlled meds | Pharmaceutical waste kit              |
| Controlled student meds       | Controlled / medication kit (Form 41) |

### Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back suits most school offices. A district managing many schools? We'll size a program — get a quote at [easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote](https://easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote) or call 501-904-2929.

### WHY SCHOOL HEALTH OFFICES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

## Ready to simplify your school health office waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · [sales@easyrxcycle.com](mailto:sales@easyrxcycle.com) · [easyrxcycle.com/shop](https://easyrxcycle.com/shop)